LEFT FUNCTION

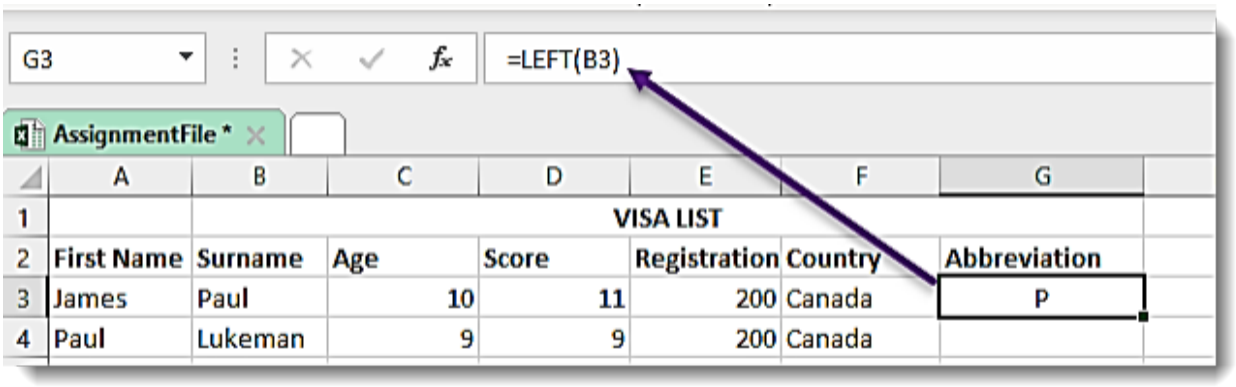
The **LEFT** function extracts a specified number of characters from the beginning of a text string. It returns the first character or characters in the original text string that satisfy the formula's conditions.

For example, if you have a very long text in a cell and only want to display the first few characters, the **LEFT** function can help extract and display a specified amount of characters from the beginning of the text string.

The **LEFT** Function Syntax is:

LEFT(text, number of characters)

However, the **LEFT** function chooses **1** as its default number of characters to display, except you specify a number that must be greater than 0.



	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1		VISA LIST					
2	First Name	Surname	Age	Score	Registration	Country	Abbreviation
3	James	Paul	10	11	200	Canada	P
4	Paul	Lukeman	9	9	200	Canada	

Using the **LEFT** function without specifying the number of characters to extract forces the formula to use the default number 1.

In the example given, the **LEFT** function was used to create an abbreviation of the name in cell **B3** by extracting the first letter of the Text.

If you want to retrieve the 2 first letters, the formula will become: